

NEVE

by VRCVS · quick guide



Snow falls, tears run down. Every snowflake plays a low note, every tear plays a high note. The third voice is yours, on the grid. All three follow the same harmony, which adapts to the scale by itself.

The three voices

 Snow low notes Every flake that hits the bottom plays a note. It follows the chord, like an upright bass.	 Tears high notes Every tear that detaches plays a note. It repeats a short motif and varies it.	 Live your notes You play it on the grid, always inside the scale. The other two voices listen to you.
---	---	---

Where the sound goes

Every voice has its own outputs, even several at once. An example: (PARAMS > voice 1 / 2 / 3)

	Synth engine	MIDI	Just Friends
 Snow	☒ on	☐ off	☐ off
 Tears	☐ off	☒ on	☐ off
 Live	☐ off	☐ off	☒ on

Only one synth engine at a time: PolyPerc or mx.samples (PARAMS > sound > synth engine). Switching it reloads the script: the screen freezes for a few seconds, then the cover returns and you press K3. With mx.samples every voice has its own instrument.

Getting started

1 Copy NEVE.lua into dust/code/NEVE/ and load it from SELECT	2 Press K3 on the cover to start everything	3 Listen and play turn the encoders, touch the grid, turn the arc
--	---	---

Three styles: PARAMS > generative > style

slow cell (default)

4 notes at a fixed rhythm, slow chords, pedal snow.

arpeggio

Steady arpeggio with a long top note.

snow (random)

Randomly falling notes, busier.

On the norns

Keys, encoders and the six parameter pages



simplified drawing, the real position of the controls may differ

What they do

- K3** On the cover: start
- K2** Pause / resume
- K3** Go to the next harmony
- E1** Change page (there are 6)
- E2 E3** The two parameters of the page

When you turn an encoder, its name and value appear at the bottom for two seconds.

The 6 pages of E1

1/6 E2 amount E3 frequency	2/6 E2 melodic var. E3 rhythmic var.	3/6 E2 velocity min E3 velocity max
4/6 E2 root E3 scale	5/6 E2 delay E3 reverb	6/6 E2 live velocity E3 live octave

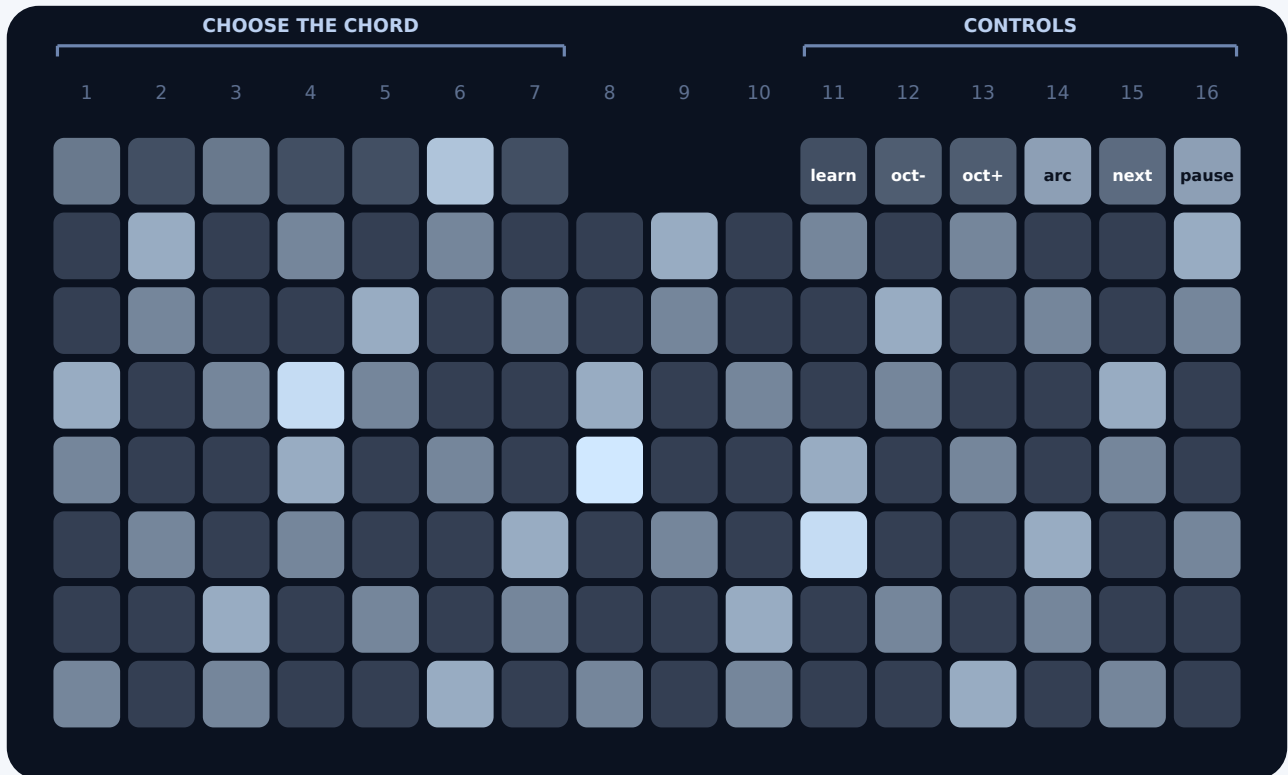
All the other parameters are in the PARAMS menu: outputs per voice, scale and harmony, quantization, delay, reverb.

Things to remember

- **Scale and root**
page 4: pick any mode from musicutil.
- **More or fewer notes**
page 1: "amount" is how many flakes fall, "frequency" how often.
- **Calmer or more tension**
page 2: low "melodic var." = repetitive, gentle melodies.
- **Space**
page 5: delay and reverb act on the synth, not on MIDI or Just Friends.

The grid

Controls on the top row, a keyboard to play below



Row 1

- 1 - 7** One pad per note of the scale. Press = choose the chord starting on that note.
7-note scale = 7 pads. Bright = stable chords; nearly off = clash (nearest one plays).
- 11** learn: your notes become the motif of the tears.
- 12 · 13** octave down · octave up for the keyboard.
- 14** arc page (1 → 2 → 3 → 1).
- 15 · 16** next harmony · pause / resume.

Rows 2-8: the keyboard

- | | |
|--|--|
|  scale note |  scale root |
|  current chord note |  chord root |
|  note just played by snow or tears |  key you are pressing |

Every key is a note of the scale, so you cannot go wrong. The brightest ones are the chord notes: the safest, and they change by themselves with the harmony.

Touch

the note starts

Hold

the note sustains

Release

the note stops

Falling flakes and tears appear dimly on the grid. In PARAMS > live (grid) choose quantization (free, 1/16, 1/8, 1/4), velocity and octave.

The arc

Four rings, three pages of parameters



How to use it

Turn a ring to change the parameter: its name and value appear at the bottom of the norms. Change page with pad 14 on row 1 of the grid.



The rings flash when:

- 1 a flake falls
- 2 a tear falls
- 3 you play the grid
- 4 the harmony changes

Too slow or too fast? Change `ARC_SENS` at the top of `NEVE.lua` (higher = faster). If the rings do not light up, look in maiden: it prints "NEVE arc error".

Learn, parameters and problems

To find things quickly

Learn: teach a motif to the tears



Where to find the parameters (PARAMS menu)

sound	synth engine (PolyPerc / mx.samples), MIDI device
voice 1: snow	outputs, synth volume, instrument, MIDI, Just Friends for the snow
voice 2: tears	the same things, for the tears
voice 3: live	the same things, for the voice you play
scale & harmony	scale, root, octave, progression (auto), how many beats per chord
generative	style, arpeggio, amount, frequency, variations, velocity, length, wind
live (grid)	live quantization, velocity, octave, learn
delay & reverb	level, time, feedback, tone, length and damping

If something is wrong

- **I hear nothing**
check "synth engine out" and "synth volume" of the voice: at 0 it is silent (synth only).
- **mx.samples silent or with errors**
after K3 the screen says why, e.g. "mx: no samples installed" (download samples).
- **Presets and engine switch**
starts with defaults; a preset restores everything, engine included (if it changes, the screen pauses briefly).
- **Wrong octave on Just Friends**
adjust "Just Friends octave" of the voice.
- **Tears clash with you**
the notes you hold count: stay on the bright keys of the grid.
- **No reverb or delay**
they only act on the internal synth; check the level and the voice output.
- **Error in maiden**
copy the message (shown in red) and send it to me.

First run: keep the maiden console open. Tested only in a simulator, not on a real norms.